

INFORM

THE OWN WAY OF DOING THINGS.

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Dear Readers

Welcome to the first issue of Inform, our new company magazine, in which we report twice per year on novelties, experiences and topics from the PET and PAC branches, our environment and our everyday life. It is my hope that the publication is good reading for you and that you'll gain interesting insight in our world. Intensive contacts with our customers, partners and suppliers are very important to me.

This is evident from the article on Logoplaste in Cascais. This Portuguese enterprise and we cooperate in close partnership which goes back to the company founders. As typical Swiss company, we are constantly looking for new solutions and adjust our services to the needs of the market. The revolutionary Cappello design and the economically efficient thin-wall technology are two examples which we present in this issue. Quality and reliability as well as a balanced price/performance ratio are the basis for a long-term partnership and sustained profits.

A major contribution to this is made by our employees, on whose competences, business attitude and loyalty we can rely at all times. Josef and Marcel Thum are two salient examples. A few years back, son Marcel took over the apprentices workshop started by his father nearly 60 years ago and presently trains no less than 16 young people to become able professionals. Our new magazine in your hands is also based on our constant striving to lead our traditional enterprise onto new paths. We wish you pleasant reading and look forward to your reaction.

Yours, Otto Hofstetter
CEO Otto Hofstetter AG



Title page.

Stefan Zatti, Otto Hofstetter and Stanislaus Spörri (from left to right), fully optimistic about keeping Otto Hofstetter AG on the right track also in future.

Imprint.

Inform. Issue 1, 2011.

Publication of Otto Hofstetter AG, Uznach, Switzerland.

Overall responsibility: Stefan Zatti.

Agency: BSSM Werbeagentur AG, Basel, Switzerland.

Copies published: 10,000.

Printed by Effingerhof AG, Brugg, Switzerland.

Appears in spring and autumn each year.



The cooperation between **Logoplaste and Otto Hofstetter AG** dates back to the first-generation founders of the firms. It began with a tool for Portuguese yoghurt. Since then the two companies have grown, Logoplaste into one of the most important companies for rigid plastic packaging. Inform met with its owner and **CEO, Filipe de Botton**, and the **Head of the Innovation Lab, Paulo Correia**, in its headquarters in Cascais and spoke with him about his firm and its partnership with Otto Hofstetter AG.



"WE MAINTAIN A VERY
POSITIVE ATTITUDE, IN DEEDS,
NOT IN WORDS."

Filipe de Botton

Logoplaste CEO, Filipe de Botton, leads his company with far-reaching vision and great commitment.

You established your company in 1976 and now you have 60 locations in 18 countries worldwide. Mr de Botton, what is the recipe of your success?

There is no recipe really. At least nothing secret. We basically have a team that has a very entrepreneurial mindset and skills and competences that enable us to be among the best in every country where we operate and in every activity that we engage in. This mindset has guided Logoplaste in executing our plan and in relating to our main partners. We talk about partners upstream and downstream. Upstream includes firms like Otto Hofstetter. Downstream would be customers like Danone, Nestlé and Procter & Gamble. We have developed a special way of working that is driven by this entrepreneurial behaviour. It is based on our ethical values and makes us a company with a distinctive face and name, one where if you've been our partner you may have worked with Paulo Correia for the last 20 years. There is a value to this long-term relationship, one that can be felt whatever problems might arise, or despite any questions and challenges that need to be resolved. We maintain a very positive attitude that clearly seeks to build a win-win situation at the end of the day, in deeds and not just in words.

What are your plans concerning markets and growth?

We have 64 factories in the 18 countries where we are present. We are in Europe from Portugal to Russia. We are in the Americas, in Canada, the US, Mexico and Brazil. And we have decided now to enter the Southeast Asian market. Southeast Asia, for us, means Malaysia, Vietnam, Indonesia and the Philippines. It means setting up factories there and building a new regional headquarters in Kuala Lumpur. It also means helping us to maintain our growth rate. In the last 19 years we have grown at 17 % per year. In 2009 our growth rate rose to almost 20 %, then in 2010 to 25 %, and in 2011 we will grow at close to 30 %. Next year we intend to grow again by at least 20 %. And the only way we can achieve that is by staying focused. We have been able to grow consistently thanks to our ability to make use of the best of what each culture we operate in has to offer and by learning from all our customers and stakeholders, both upstream and downstream. We try to apply what we learn from them along our entire supply chain, to work to understand their requirements and also to offer them advice.

Logoplaste is an owner-managed company. How do you maintain this organizational structure while pursuing the growth you mentioned?

Clearly by respecting other cultures. As I said, we consider ourselves a unique company with our own way of doing things. Nevertheless, we adapt to the local cultures where we operate. We don't try to impose on them. While we believe in following the "golden rules" we have set down for our organization, we always remain aware of the local ways of doing things. So, in Malaysia, for instance, which is mostly a Muslim country, we have set up prayer rooms in our factories so people can respect their own tradition and beliefs. That is something you don't have in Switzerland, for example. We think it is important to adapt to and remain open toward what is best in each land. Now, we can only grow and follow our plan because we have a strong tradition of innovation. What we sell, rigid plastic packaging, is a commodity. Many other companies in the world are equal to us in terms of quality, price, etc. The way you differentiate yourself is through innovation, by rethinking your processes, by understanding how in fact you can make things different, better, and deliver more value to your partner. And this is what we do in our innovation lab, in the department that Paulo Correia runs. We have people in Portugal, in Chicago and in São Paulo in Brazil who are constantly innovating. And in the next 12 months we will have staff in Kuala Lumpur in Malaysia. We benefit from this cross-fertilization of cultures, of different outlooks and different approaches to the same problem.

"THE WAY YOU DIFFERENTIATE YOURSELF IS BY RETHINKING YOUR PROCESSES."

Filipe de Botton, CEO of Logoplaste

"The more we grow, the more we will rely on each individual." This quote attests to the confidence you have in your staff. What enables you to have such confidence?

It is an attitude. If you rely on people, if you trust and empower them, they will feel responsible. If you want to manage a company that extends from Vancouver in Canada to Kuantan in Malaysia, that encompasses 16 time zones, you need to trust people. Because of our business model, we might have small facilities integrated fully into the production processes of our partners. So the head of these facilities are the bosses of their own company. It is part of the culture we've developed and it revolves around trusting people. The only thing you need to have in addition is a good control

system. We have an excellent IT system that enables us to empower people, because it's up to them to seize the opportunity, to make decisions, and then to be responsible for them. So, if you buy a mall but not from Otto Hofstetter, obviously you made the wrong decision. But you still bought it and you are responsible for that decision. We've staked out a set of boundaries and people know them and know that they can act within them. They will be accountants for us at the end of the day.

Logoplaste is an incorporator of "Societe Ponto Verde" and supports a non-profit organization to promote the "Cadin" project for children. Is it important to you to put your values into practice?

Yes, that's really the point. It's not just about growing and making money and having new businesses. The point is to give something back to society. My father started with the idea of launching this green idea in Portugal, "Societe Ponto Verde", where material is collected and recycled. And then we extended our support to "Cadin". Today we have over fourteen thousand, yes, fourteen thousands families with children who are affected by mental disorders such as Down's syndrome, hyperactivity, dyslexia, autism, those kinds of difficulties. We just try to help the children and their families to be happier and more integrated into society. When it comes to values, it's more important for us to do something than just talk about it. Today Cadin exists thanks to the over 2,000 people working at our company who support it.



Filipe de Botton sees one of the keys to the success of Logoplaste in the Logoplaste Innovation Lab.

Heinz, Coca Cola, Nestlé: Your customer portfolio includes some of the world's most valuable brands. Why do they choose Logoplaste to package these brands?

What our customers are looking for is added value, and the main reason they work with us is because we deliver a level and a quality of service that they can't find elsewhere. Yes, we're a small Portuguese company but nowadays clearly international. So why should, say, Heinz work with us? I think that being highly competent and professional but also Latin works to our advantage because we are open to lateral thinking, to thinking out of the box. Maybe more so than a company from a northern country or from an Asian culture, where I would say the template is much more rigid. If you look at Portuguese history, we were the ones who went around the globe exploring, pushing beyond boundaries. That's exactly what Paulo Correia and his team do every single day. They try to find something different, something not thought of before. Sometimes we ask our main suppliers things and they say, "It's impossible". But then we prove that it's not impossible, it's just different. And that's probably why customers choose us, this culture we have of "never say no." It's ingrained in us, this constant rethinking, this refusal to accept something as definitive.

"OTTO HOFSTETTER IS PROBABLY THE MOST PORTUGUESE-SWISS COMPANY I KNOW."

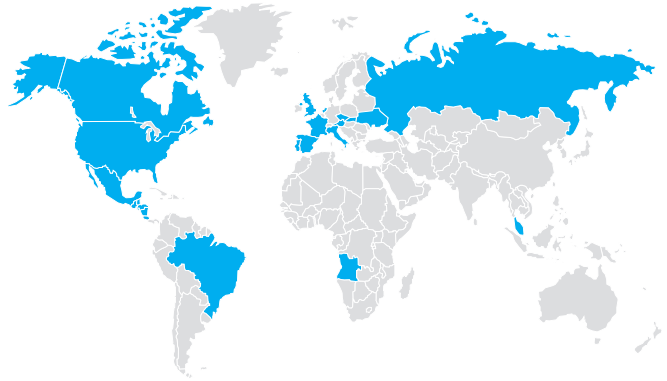
Paulo Correia, Head of the Logoplaste Innovation Lab

Logoplaste operates at a very high level. Your supplier Otto Hofstetter and others have to do so as well.

In fact, they challenge us. That's why we like to work with a company like Otto Hofstetter. We want to challenge our partners downstream, our stakeholders, and we can only do so when we're being challenged upstream by suppliers like Otto Hofstetter. They also have a very open attitude that enables us to have this dialogue and constant exchange of information with them, which is what makes things happen.

So having a kind of sparring partner makes you fitter and more efficient in your business?

Having an intellectual sparring partner, yes, exactly. It's a positive challenge, and we don't like to lose challenges. Of course, you do need to know how to lose sometimes, how to fail, but to fail fast. In Portuguese we have this saying about going from defeat to defeat until the final victory. And this is pretty much what you have to do. You have to keep your ultimate goals in view in order to achieve them.



Are there other attitudes at Otto Hofstetter that you like?

Paulo Correia: What I can say here is that Otto Hofstetter is probably the most Portuguese-Swiss company I know, which is obviously meant as a compliment. It means, as Filipe was saying, that they have the capability, the flexibility to adjust to our needs and act fast. That has made possible the strong, close, professional relationship we've developed over the years.

What are your main goals and concerns for the future – first, as a company and, second, as an individual, Mr de Botton?

We want to create a company environment where everybody feels at home and feels part of it, feels like a part-owner of the company. We want people to be happy, to feel respected and create a culture where they respect other people. I would say that by and large we can say that we have created this culture and we feel comfortable with it. As a company, if we can succeed globally, if in, say, 10 years' time we can be among the three top companies in the world



The team in the Logoplaste Innovation Lab ensure the continual development of the Portuguese company.

as a rigid plastic producer, we will feel that we have accomplished our mission. And then in the 10 years after that we could set our sights on being the No. 1 company, which I think we can be, I think we can achieve that goal. Our main concern is our people. You can only have a successful company if you have a successful team, and you can only have a successful team if you have a successful company. So obviously you need to have both at the same time. And that's the interesting thing about managing the company and working together with people, you have to keep them engaged, committed and passionate. You probably spend most of your life at work or with your company, more than you do even at home. So if you feel comfortable and you feel happy and you enjoy what you are doing, I think that's probably why we are successful at managing the company and putting our values into practice.

**"YOU CAN ONLY HAVE A
SUCCESSFUL COMPANY IF YOU
HAVE A SUCCESSFUL TEAM
AND VICE VERSA."**

Filipe de Botton

Is there anything you want to add for the readers of this first issue?

There is one thing we also want to say, and that's that you can only grow if you have very, very reliable and competent partners upstream. And I should say that Otto Hofstetter is probably one of the most supportive and trustworthy partners we've had in our history. And I'm not making this

statement for the sake of this magazine. It is an honest statement which, I think, is shared by everyone in our company. We feel comfortable working with Otto Hofstetter, we trust Otto Hofstetter as a company, and we're excited to tackle the challenges of the future and achieve great things together with them. Working with Otto Hofstetter is something we appreciate doing.

Mr de Botton, thanks for this insightful and open conversation.

 **LOGOPLASTE**

Logoplaste is an industrial group that manufactures rigid plastic packaging for some of the most reputable companies in the world in the food and beverage, personal care, household care and oil and lubricants sectors.

Founded in 1976, Logoplaste today manages 64 factories with more than 250 machines in 18 countries around the world. It employs the most up-to-date technologies in injection moulding, stretch-blow moulding and extrusion moulding to produce packages across a range of market segments. Its unique business model is based on the hole-in-the-wall concept, which means that a Logoplaste company is integrated into the customer's building and infrastructure. The Logoplaste Innovation Lab researches and develops high-performance plastic packaging solutions using a 360° methodology.

www.logoplaste.com



This company with 64 subsidiaries in 18 countries is controlled from its head office in Cascais.

TRADITIONALLY COMMITTED TO PROGRESS.

The Geneva-based luxury watch manufacturer [Urwerk](#) ranks among the most innovative manufacturers in Switzerland. Their creations combine [handcraft skills](#) that have been maintained across generations with the possibilities afforded by [leading-edge technology](#). It's a typical Swiss recipe that Otto Hofstetter AG is also committed to. And the latest example: [the Cappello design for preforms](#).

"I'm fascinated by the precision and sophistication with which the individual parts of the movements are made, and by the innovative drive with which the young pioneers repeatedly dare to break the rules of watchmaking that are commonly held to be set in stone." Otto Hofstetter, CEO of Otto Hofstetter AG, is not talking about his injection moulds, but is expressing his fascination for the watches made by Urwerk.

Committed to precision.

"Our watches are unique because each one has been designed as an original. This makes them valuable and rare. Above all else, we seek to move beyond the traditional horizons of watchmaking and explore new dimensions." Martin Frei, responsible for the design of the new timepiece, helps to make this possible. "I come from a world of total creative freedom and don't have a sense of allegiance to traditional shapes. It allows me to draw my inspiration from my entire cultural heritage." If it were down to the opinion of Otto Hofstetter, the young watch manufacturer has already achieved this in a masterly fashion.

**"THE SWISS LUXURY WATCH BRAND
URWERK UPHOLDS MASTERLY
WATCHMAKING SKILLS WITHOUT
ANY COMPROMISES."**

Otto Hofstetter, CEO Otto Hofstetter AG

A newcomer with old values.

Urwerk comprises the visions and conceptions of both founding partners and turns the eccentric creations into sensational watchmaking artistry. For Felix Baumgartner, a watchmaker as his father and grandfather had also been, time literally runs through his arteries. As a model student

at the watchmaking school in Schaffhausen, Felix learnt the secret language of minute repetition, the tourbillon and the perpetual calendar right from scratch. Martin Frei is the artistic antithesis to the technical knowledge of his partner. At the Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Arts, Martin studied every shape of visual artistic expression and progressed to become an up-and-coming artist. When both men met by pure coincidence, they discovered their mutual fascination for time measurement. They spent hours analyzing the differences between the watches they had seen in shops and their visions.

Inspiration that goes beyond the industry.

During the history of their still young company, the Geneva-based powerhouse of ideas has developed watch models that are held in high esteem within the industry. One of the most unconventional watches of all time must be the UR-202 Turbine Automatic. It consists of a novel design



for an automatic watch movement in conjunction with two fans, as well as an entirely new housing design, face and displays.

"CUTTING-EDGE TECHNOLOGY AND TRADITIONAL HANDCRAFT SKILLS FORM THE BASIS OF EVERY DECISIVE INNOVATION."

Otto Hofstetter

"We are committed to progress, but without sacrificing the traditions and time-honoured craftsmanship inherent in fine watchmaking." This declaration by Felix Baumgartner and Martin Frei shows the strong parallels between the philosophy of the Swiss luxury watch manufacturer and that of Otto Hofstetter AG. And it also provides an insight into why Otto Hofstetter Junior is such a devotee of Urwerk.

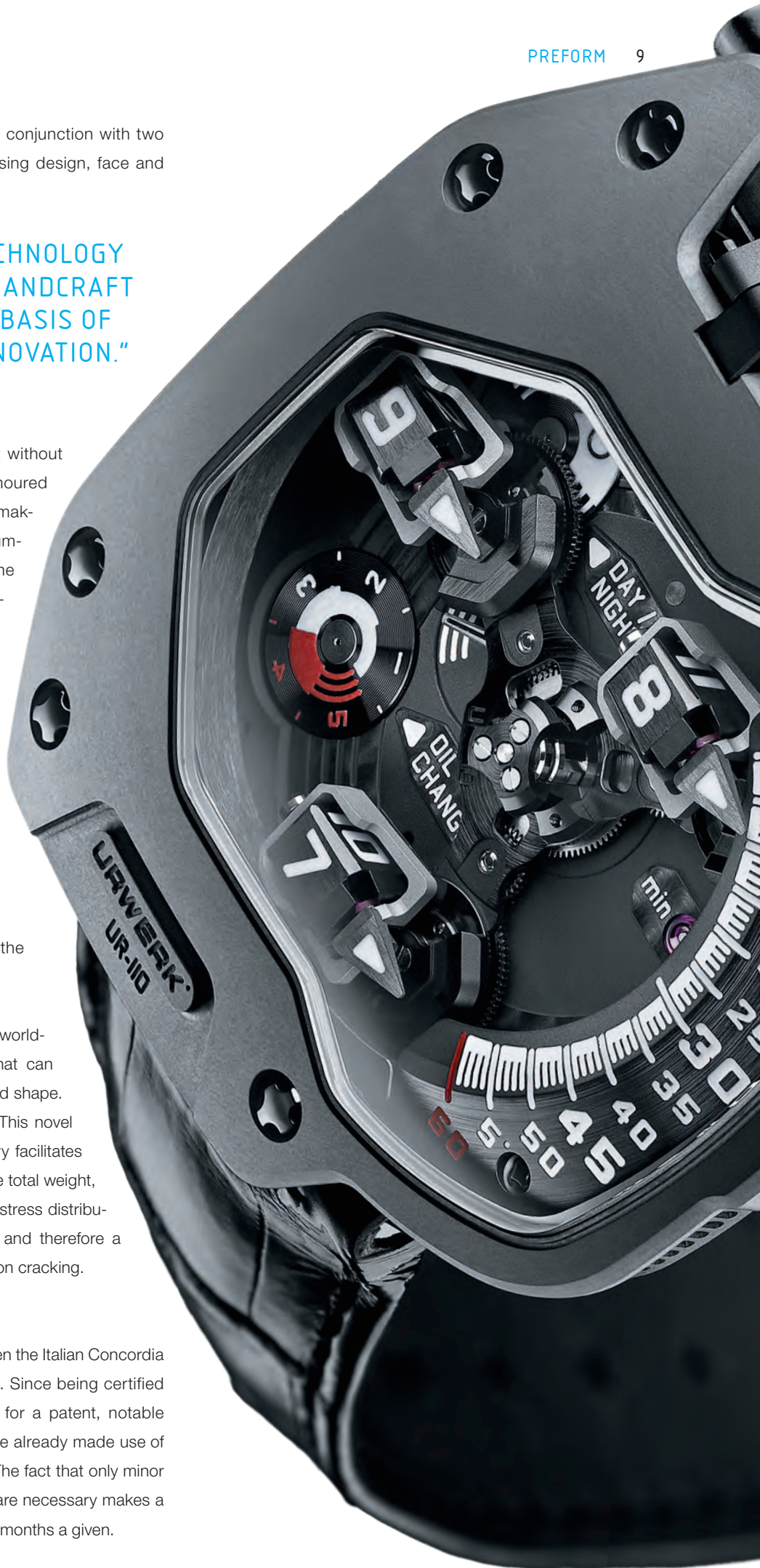
Success with Cappello.

Combining cutting-edge technology with traditional handcraft skills in order to allow innovations to develop is also one of the strengths of Otto Hofstetter. This is evident in the latest example: "Cappello".

Cappello design is a revolutionary and world-wide patented preform technology that can be employed for every possible finished shape. The big advantage of the innovation: This novel preform with its special base geometry facilitates raw materials savings of 3 to 5 % of the total weight, guarantees uniform – if not superior – stress distribution across the eventual bottle base and therefore a lower tendency towards stress corrosion cracking.

Exemplary teamwork.

Cappello is a joint development between the Italian Concordia Development and Otto Hofstetter AG. Since being certified by PTI Europe and their application for a patent, notable customers from across the globe have already made use of this raw materials saving technology. The fact that only minor changes to the existing infrastructure are necessary makes a return-on-investment period of 6 to 12 months a given.



Highlights of the Cappello technology.

- Preform weight reduction of 3 to 5 %.
- Very short investment amortization time.
- No need to change over the blowing equipment.
- No adaptations of the stretch rod.
- Less raw material to be injected results in shorter injection time.
- Higher quality of the bottle base.

Small detail resulting in major advantages.

Thanks to the novel shape based on the Cappello design the preform base is 15 to 20 % lighter than that of a conventional preform. Moreover, the base is markedly more suitable to be stretched to its final shape. It must be emphasized that only the preform's base geometry is affected by the Cappello design and the weight reduction. All other parts of the preform retain the technical specifications of a standard preform.

Technology and craftsmanship.

Otto Hofstetter AG participated in the Cappello development in two ways. On the one hand, the company supported the Italian partner with its solid know-how in the area of preform design and supplied the required mould parts, and on the other, it was involved in feasibility studies, ran test series and documented the resulting data.

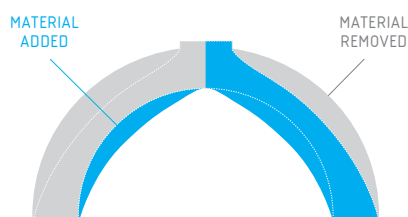
Concordia Development looked for an experienced and innovative mouldmaker able to produce the necessary steel parts and mould the test series. Due to a lack of contacts in the PET industry, Filippo Pagliacci, lawyer and CEO of the development company domiciled in Milano, sought an expert partner with first-class connections in the branch.

Applied all over the world.

The new development of Concordia Development and Otto Hofstetter AG reached series maturity already after one year of intensive work. One of the most crucial points was to explain to potential customers that the preform's new base geometry saves much raw material without impairing

the quality of the PET bottle. In the meantime, the industry is well aware of this big plus, and the annual production of Cappello preforms has grown to far over 6 billion pieces. The successful team has no intention of resting on its laurels, however.

THE CAPPELLO DESIGN MAKES THE BASE OF A PREFORM UP TO 20% LIGHTER.



The development continues.

With the objective of finding new base contours which save yet more weight and thereby valuable raw material, improvements are tested on an ongoing basis and the development is further refined. Urwerk, maker of luxury watches, and Otto Hofstetter AG are typical Swiss enterprises also in this respect: they are constantly searching for new solutions which meet the requirements of the customers and of the market.



CAPPELLO SAVES MUCH RAW MATERIAL WHILE THE QUALITY IS FULLY IDENTICAL WITH THAT OF CONVENTIONAL PREFORMS.

Conversion of a 128-cav. mould for a customer in Dubai.

Calculating example:

Cost-benefit in the 1st year of operation

Saving of raw material cost	EUR	171,000,-
Mould conversion cost, total	EUR	134,400,-

Net saving in first year of operation	EUR	36,600,-
Amortization period		287 days

Cost-benefit in the first 5 years after conversion

Saving of raw material cost, 1st year	EUR	36,600,-
Saving of raw material cost, year 2 to 5	EUR	4 × 171,000,-

Net savings in 5 years	EUR	720,600,-
Weight of raw material saved in 5 years		570,000 kg



EMIRATES FLIES ON THIN-WALL TECHNOLOGY.



Picture: KEYSTONE

The moulds for the drinking cups used in the latest A 380 of Emirates Airways are made by Otto Hofstetter AG.

Reduction of the wall thickness is a constant topic with the packaging and PET preform industries. Less raw material means to both of them shorter cycle times, lower costs and less weight. No wonder airlines favour the highly developed thin-wall technology in the production of their packaging products.

Small saving, big effect.

A little numbers game to start with: Thanks to the thin-wall technology of Otto Hofstetter AG a weight saving of 0.5 grams was achieved in the drinking cup of Emirates Air-

ways. Projected to the annual total consumption, the weight saving amounts to 40 tons. Considering that the payload of an aircraft is always seen in relation to the kerosene consumption, 40 tons of material saved correspond to almost

13,000 gallons of fuel. If we take an A 380 with 550 passengers on board, the countervalue of the saved polystyrene corresponds to a flight from Zurich to Boston.

THE THIN-WALL TECHNOLOGY OF OTTO HOFSTETTER AG DOUBLES THE PRODUCTION CAPACITY AND GUARANTEES A RAPID RETURN-OF-INVESTMENT.

Convincing advantages.

A constructed calculation, we admit. But even from a purely factual point of view the thin-wall technology of Otto Hofstetter AG is a high-flyer. In the case of the 8-cavity mould the original cycle time of six seconds has been halved. With a production around the clock and 95% efficiency, approximately 80 million parts are produced per year – this is twice the original output. The clearly higher procurement cost hasn't deterred the customer from buying the high-output moulds from Otto Hofstetter AG.

Security thanks to own experience and tests.

Otto Hofstetter AG draws from its more than 50 years experience in thin-walled products also in the field of PET. The proverbial stability of Hofstetter moulds was the decisive factor for the implementation of thinner walls in the preform. All existing preform designs can be subjected to a feasibility study concerning a reduction of the wall thickness. If necessary, test series can be run on the test moulds of Otto Hofstetter AG. A decisive factor in the development was the axial stretching ratio between preform and, for example, bottle, which may be maximum 3. To establish the conditions exactly, the newly developed preforms were tested on Hofstetter's own test moulds.

Well proven in everyday production.

Enterprises such as Resilux, PDG, Köksan and Sunpet already use the new thin-wall technology in the production of their preforms. A total of 17 systems with up to 128

8 -CAVITY MOULD

3 -SECOND CYCLE

-0.5 GRAMS LESS PER CUP

24^H OPERATION, 95% EFFICIENCY

80 MILLION CUPS

40 TONS OF MATERIAL SAVED

cavities each are in operation and produce wall thicknesses of less than 2 millimetres. And first tests with even further reduced wall thicknesses have already yielded positive results.

Basis for further development.

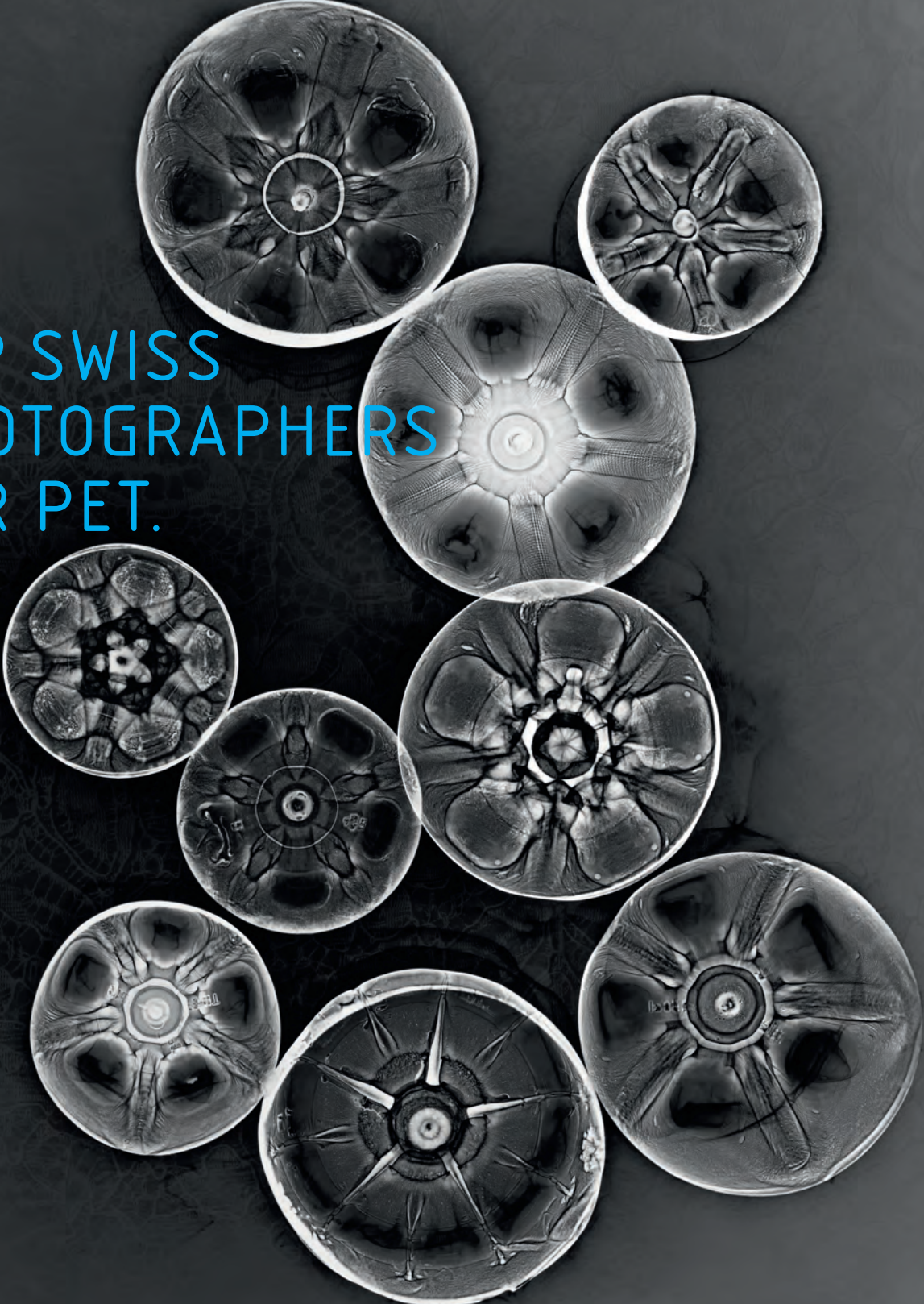
Initial experience with the new technology shows that the injection moulding machine must provide more locking force and a higher plasticizing capacity. An unchanged high quality of the preform as regards even wall thickness and freedom from flash calls for yet higher precision in mould making. Efficient venting of the mould is a must and the wear parts need to stand up to higher strains. Design measures must be introduced to make the bottle more rigid and give it the usual handling stability.

Thinner still in future.

Otto Hofstetter's hunger for further innovation in the thin-wall technology is not yet satisfied. In the case of long preforms, the thickness must be further

reduced to achieve the minimum specified weight. Yet higher locking forces and injection pressures are unavoidable. The specialists of the development department keep at it.





TOP SWISS PHOTOGRAPHERS FOR PET.

By international standards, Switzerland can be proud of a high **PET recycling quota** of **more than 80 %**. The trade organization PET Recycling Switzerland wants more and, with this in mind, engaged **top Swiss photographers**. The project **“PET is fashion”** attracted much attention way beyond the country’s borders.

Next to major efforts in saving raw materials with novel concepts such as the Cappello design and thin-wall technology, the reuse of PET enjoys highest priority in the agendas of many companies and organizations. The trade association PET Recycling Switzerland was founded in 1990 and devotes itself to the collection of used PET beverage bottles. It has meanwhile established a disposal network covering the whole of Switzerland.

Recycling rate above 80 %.

PET Recycling Switzerland increased the recycling rate of PET to 81% within the last 20 years. A good result also by international standards and placing Switzerland ahead of countries where a deposit is charged per bottle. This success is due to an optimal cooperation between beverage industry, retail trade and end users.

Quality photography for higher recycling rate.

PET Recycling Switzerland won some of the best Swiss fashion photographers for an idea: Sven Bänziger, Hans Feurer, Anoush & Aimée, Diana Scheunemann and Walter Pfeiffer, to name but a few. They drew attention to the PET bottle within the framework of project "PET is fashion". PET Recycling Switzerland worded the task very openly in order not to restrict the creativity. The only condition was that the PET bottle was placed in the focus like in a fashion shooting – either to play the leading role or as a natural part of the photo scenery. This resulted in the most varied pictures reflecting the entirely personal style of each photographer, from the delicate body of a women to the Swiss mountain landscape. The only common denominator is the PET bottle.

PET recycling protects the environment.

The pictures are to make it clear that PET is by now firmly established also in the fashion scene. Although the collected and recycled PET bottles serve primarily to make new bottles, their material is increasingly used also for the production of new high-tech polyester fabrics, for example for cocktail dresses or snowboard jackets. The clothing industry thus sets an example for the protection of the environment. In Switzerland alone, 139,000 tons of greenhouse gases (mostly CO₂) and 36 million litres of crude oil were saved last year thanks to PET recycling.

SWITZERLAND AS INSPIRATION.

Photographers participating in project "PET is fashion":

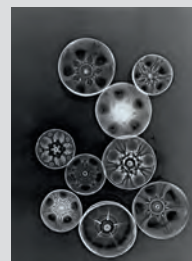
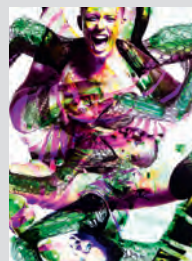
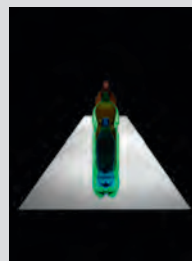
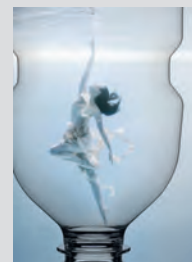
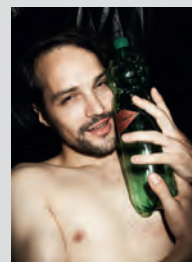
- Valentin Jeck
- Patrick Fuchs
- Pierluigi Macor
- Sven Bänziger
- Sarah Maurer
- Walter Pfeiffer
- Philipp Müller
- Sandra Kennel
- Zoren Gold Minori (otherwise known as MIZO)
- Diana Scheunemann
- Hans Feurer
- Anoush Abrar & Aimée Hoving
- Raphael Just

More information on the photographers/teams and their work can be looked up under www.petinside.ch.

Some of the gossip given out by the "PET is fashion" photographers in the interview: The pair of photographers Anoush & Aimée, for example, allowed themselves to be inspired by Switzerland. Sarah Maurer discloses which ballet dancer provided her ghost of the bottle with the necessary grace. The QR code leads you behind the scenes and to all interviews with the artists involved in the project.



All of the photos taken by the Swiss fine art photographers were generously made available to Inform by PET Recycling Switzerland.



PROFESSIONAL TRAINING IS SOMETHING PARTICULARLY SWISS.

In Switzerland, schools and enterprises share the task of training competent professionals. The system is highly practice-related and rather unusual by international standards. But it has a long tradition and is regarded as a success model for the future.

Seven times Gold, twice Silver and five times Bronze were won by the Swiss Delegation at the World Skills Contest in Calgary. This makes Switzerland the leading nation in Europe and places it worldwide in the second position after South Korea. A success which hasn't come by chance.

"ANYONE WITH LITTLE AMBITION IS LESS SUITABLE."

Marcel Thum, Head of the Trainees Workshop at OHAG

Training as a basis.

Vocational training is a cornerstone of the Swiss economy. Well trained specialists and executives contribute to the high quality of the workplace Switzerland. This is of high importance to the national economy as a whole. The enterprises increase their productivity and achieve competitive advantages, while the employees secure their position in the labour market and enhance their career opportunities. Society benefits from economic innovation and social stability.

Practice orientation is a central aspect.

Very high importance has been attached to the professional education in Switzerland for many decades. Otto Hofstetter AG is no exception. "We started with 2 apprentices and expanded steadily to currently 16", explains Josef Thum. He joined Otto Hofstetter AG in 1958 and remained with the company until his retirement 3 years ago. The trainees, originally spread throughout the works and rotating at regular intervals, were looked after by him for many years.

One of the characteristics of job training in Switzerland, and possibly one of the secrets of its success, is practice orientation. Training relies mostly on traineeships, in fact 90% of the trainees are trained in companies. "It is our aim at Otto Hofstetter AG that the training is as practice-oriented as possible."

Integrated in everyday production.

The apprentices workshop is equipped with the most modern machinery and fully integrated in the company's production process. The multitude of parts permits to confront the trainees with suitable, but entirely realistic tasks at all levels of their training, praises Marcel Thum, now Manager of the apprentices workshop, the benefits of the Swiss training model. "It is important for the apprentices to appreciate that a concrete order is concerned. If the result doesn't satisfy our high quality demands or if the delivery deadline is at risk, it happens by all means that we work overtime in our workshop. We try to pass on what it's all about in the job, and this on scale 1:1."

"FINGERTIP FEELING AND GRASP CHARACTERIZE THE COMPETENT POLYMECHANIC."

Josef Thum, retired apprentices teacher at OHAG

The nature of the vocational training may be a further reason why it is held in such high esteem in Switzerland. It embodies typical Swiss values such as sense of duty, reliability, punctuality and the striving for the best possible quality. "The ability to work well in a team is very important these days. Our trainees experience this every day when the workshop is handed an express order, which happens frequently. A total effort is then expected from each and every one, including the readiness for shift work," explains the young apprentices teacher.

Investment which pays dividends.

Swiss enterprises spend very considerable sums on the training of young professionals. In the year 2009, for example, vocational training cost 3.4 billion Swiss francs! Add to this the investments made by the companies which train



In charge of the apprentices workshop at Otto Hofstetter AG for two generations: Josef Thum and Marcel Thum.

apprentices: 4.7 billion Swiss francs according to a survey made in 2004. Comments Marcel Thum: "Investments in the apprentices workshop are actually never questioned, and nobody doubts that they are necessary. We work with the same machinery as our production."

From an overall point of view, the money spent on basic professional education is a worthwhile investment for two thirds of the companies already while the training is taking place. The income generated by the trainees exceeds the cost of their training. In the remaining third of the cases the outlay is usually recovered if the young persons in question are employed onwards after finishing their training, which saves the company recruitment and familiarization costs.

Careful selection.

The trust placed by the Swiss economy in the young ones is rewarded by the apprenticeship leavers in the form of a 90% success rate. Accordingly decisive are also the school education and the selection of the suitable school leavers. "They are usually referred to us by their father or a close friend and attend a three-day programme at our works. Apart from a metal object which each of them manufactures, they do a written test in mathematics and other subjects to reveal their level of knowledge. Sometimes we also obtain a reference from the teacher. Together with the observations in the three days we end up with a good overall picture." Marcel Thum is pleased that the selection is made in this careful manner.

"MY FATHER HAS DONE GOOD GROUNDWORK AS REGARDS THE TRAINING OF APPRENTICES."

Marcel Thum

Talents are wanted.

Although technical professions have lost some of their attractiveness, Otto Hofstetter AG has never had any trouble in recruiting talented young persons. "I preferred a good pupil from the basic level to a mediocre one from a higher level. This in the assumption that the motivation and devotion of the 'weaker' pupil would be higher and he would end up a better professional." A philosophy which Josef Thum found confirmed time and again in his many years as a teacher of apprentices.

Two-track model.

Vocational training in Switzerland is based on a dual system. Training in the company is supplemented by tuition in the training college. "In the first two years our polymechanic apprentices go to school on two days per week. There they get the basic technical training, which they complete at the end of the second year by passing intermediate exams. That's the first milestone. In the following two years, school is reduced to one day, they get a focused training and are prepared to complete the school subjects." If an apprentice does well at school, he or she can additionally go for a professional high-school diploma.

"LOYALTY ALWAYS PAYS AT OHAG."

Josef Thum

Door-opener for studies.

This is a further advantage of the Swiss vocational training model. It is based on clearly defined education possibilities and national qualification processes.

The system is characterized by a high interchangeability. Swiss professionals can choose from about 400 professional and higher-level exams and approximately 400 education courses at higher technical colleges. The diploma opens the doors to the technical colleges. "With the E-level training and the diploma, a person with completed apprenticeship can study at a college of technology and become a process or planning specialist, or a technical businessperson. In our Purchasing Department, for example, we employ experts who have taken this route."



Latest technology is available to the 16 polymechanic apprentices.

The development possibilities are very varied. The career of our young apprentices teacher shows that the education system allows for a multitude of approaches. After his 4-year apprenticeship to become a tool mechanic and five years of work in his profession, he went back to school every Friday and Saturday for two years to become a master mechanic.

Performance defines career.

"Anyone performing well permanently, revealing to be a team player and making a little extra effort always gets a chance for a step in his or her career at Otto Hofstetter AG. Be it the involvement from the start with a new piece of equipment or the accompaniment of a new product from the evaluation to its introduction. Subject to skills and motivation there is also the possibility of changing internally." Marcel Thum appreciates this openness and fairness in his employer. "It was the same already with Otto Hofstetter Senior. He was always open to new approaches and encouraged us to try them." Thum Senior attributes the fact that the company attaches so much importance to the vocational training also to the founder. "Being on the board of examiners he got insight in many operations and knew from this how important quality is also in this area."

**"IN THE FACTORY THEY LEARN
LOTS OF THINGS WHICH YOU NEVER
FIND IN A SCHOOLBOOK."**

Marcel Thum

Companies like Otto Hofstetter AG and the emphasis that is laid on practical training will probably ensure that Swiss entrants to future World Skills contests will also win "precious metal".

OTTO HOF- STETTER HAS EXPANDED.

In the summer of 2009, Otto Hofstetter AG took a new plant building into operation; it also opened a new development centre in 2011. These investments in its infrastructure provide the company with the perfect prerequisites to meet the challenges of the future.

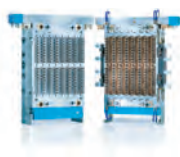
"After the expansions of 1999 and 2000 we reckoned that it would be enough. Today, 10 years later, we adjusted again to the needs of our customers and enlarged our production." For Stefan Zatti, Head of Marketing and Sales at Otto Hofstetter AG, the new production premises provide a good basis for the future. With the higher capacity, Otto Hofstetter plans to increase the number of mould units from presently 35,000 to 50,000 per year. The new Technical Centre can accommodate six injection moulding machines. One space is reserved to a customer's machine, while the other five are used for testing completed customer moulds or innovative technical developments.

After completion of the extension, the total production area at the Uznach works amounts to 11,000 sqm. Managing Director Otto Hofstetter estimates that the value of the machinery and equipment alone comes to 45 million Swiss francs. "It is only a production at the highest level that guarantees us being able to deliver moulds of highest quality within the shortest time." Among the decisive success factors next to the modern machines are the long-standing and close partnership with our customers and our perfectly trained and highly motivated workforce. Since we commissioned the new production facilities we are well prepared for the future, better than ever.





EXTRA VIRGIN.



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